

Validate first.
Pilot selectively.
Scale on evidence.

A decision agenda for the next category review

Start with supply and listing checks.
Resolve range questions before testing spend.

Executive discussion | 20 September 2026

235

products assessed

Defined scope

134

rule-matched review items

Not proven problems

5

initial product decisions

Not an automatic rollout

Approve a focused pilot—not a category-wide rollout

Three conclusions for leadership; one bounded decision to take today.

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS

MANAGEMENT IMPLICATION

- 1 Validate operational prerequisites first**
33 stock flags: 9 out of stock, 24 low stock.
2 in-stock products have zero-sales signals.
- 2 Reassess range decisions; do not automate them**
19 inactive products have growing market proxies.
The reasons for inactivity are not supplied.
- 3 Treat modeled value as a test hypothesis**
Peer benchmarks provide scenarios—not forecasts.
No realised uplift, ROI or time saving is measured.

Check supply, listings and feeds before promotional spend.

Confirm the reason for inactivity before changing the range.

Agree a baseline and test economics; expand only after observed results.

Decision requested: endorse the five checks, name accountable owners and agree pilot success criteria.

134 flagged products require three distinct responses

The complete primary-action queue—grouped by the type of management decision required.

RESPONSE / CASES

Operational validation



33 availability + 2 zero-sales checks

Range decisions



19 reactivation + 19 exit confirmation
+ 7 range / markdown + 3 seasonal reviews

Commercial review / testing



23 price comparisons + 17 promotion tests
+ 11 margin reviews

101 of 235 products matched no rule—not a validation of product health.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Diagnose the issue before spending

Validate product role before changing the range

Validate economics before a controlled test

18 assortment follow-up cells are a separate analysis—not additional SKU cases.

Assign these five checks before changing spend or range

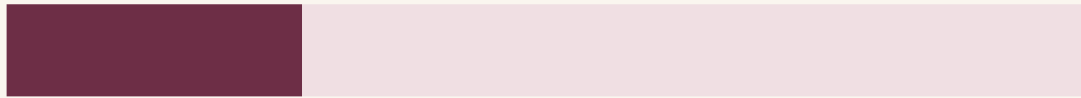
Selected for review order and breadth—not to maximise the modeled financial total.

PRODUCT / RECORD	WHY THIS DECISION	NEXT CHECK / PROPOSED OWNER
Wella Blondor · Light Blonde HC0070	Out of stock · €269.2k market proxy Market trend +26.3%	Validate stock and lead time Supply planner
Private label · Sunlit Peach HC0002	In stock · €0 sales / 0 units €64.2k market proxy · +31.0% · Summer	Check listing, feed and season E-commerce / category ops
Bleach London · White Toner HC0101	Inactive · €332.0k market proxy Market trend +17.8% · reason unknown	Understand inactivity first Category manager
Herbatint · Natural Black HC0024	24.6% margin · €30.5k revenue Also out of stock—check supply first	Validate cost / terms and supply Buyer / commercial finance
Madison Reed · Root Touch Up HC0083	In stock · channel / proxy 4.93% Peer ratio 7.33%—comparison, not share	Small test with baseline / control Category / merchandising
Keep owner, due date and accept/defer decision together; no stock, pricing or range change is automatic.		

Validate supply and listings before deploying promotion

Two operationally different signals should not receive the same commercial treatment.

AVAILABILITY QUEUE: 33 PRIMARY CASES



9 out of stock

24 low stock

€61.6k historical channel sales

For 9 cases recorded as out of stock.

Sales cover the supplied 12-week window;
stock timing and any lost sales are unknown.

A HC0070 | Validate supply

Out of stock; market trend +26.3%.

Check physical stock, feed accuracy and lead time.

B HC0002 | Validate the listing

In stock, €0 recorded sales; Summer product.

Check the listing, sales feed and selling season.

What is missing: stock duration, live listing confirmation and comparable periods—not another promotion rule.

Shortlist economics are smaller than the full scenario pool

Revenue and gross profit use independent full-queue scales. Neither is an expected return.

Revenue scenario · 12 weeks

Full queue (50 cases) **€93.0k**



Within the five-product shortlist

€10.0k 2 quantified cases



Gross profit scenario · 12 weeks

Full queue (11 cases) **€24.9k**



Within the five-product shortlist

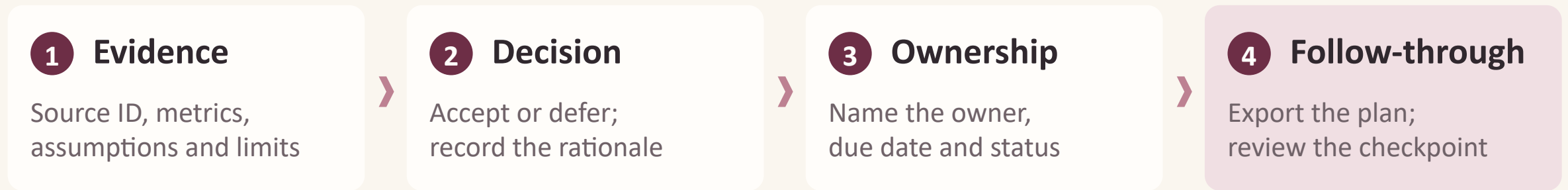
€4.4k 1 quantified case



Do not add revenue to gross profit. 2 shortlisted decisions are unquantified; no realised benefit is measured.

A review record makes each decision owned and measurable

The delivered capability is traceability and follow-through—not yet a measured commercial outcome.



PROPOSED OWNER

Category lead

Supply / e-commerce

Buyer / finance

REVIEW CHECKPOINT

Every chosen item has a decision, owner and due date.

Stock or listing/feed evidence is validated before spend.

A baseline and net gross-profit measure are agreed before testing.

Available now: browser-local review and export. Shared assignment and operational-system execution are not implemented.

Approve the checks. Make scale conditional.

1 VALIDATE

Category lead + data owners

Freshness, listing and lifecycle questions are resolved.

2 TEST

Buyer + finance

Scope, costs, baseline/control and success criteria are agreed first.

3 SCALE

Sponsor + technology owner

Review results and adoption; fund tooling only if justified.

TODAY'S ASK

Endorse the five checks | Nominate owners | Agree pilot scope and success criteria

[Open the live dashboard](#)

[Source code and evidence](#)

Source controls keep the interpretation defensible

APPENDIX A | How the review separates an observed signal from a proposed action.



SKU performance

Revenue, units, margin,
status and stock



Product metadata

Product role, supplier,
variant and seasonality



Competitor observations

Category/shade context;
comparability unverified

Validate

Required fields, joins and duplicates; preserve source IDs.

Apply guardrails

Inactive is not an automatic delist; stock issues stay visible.

Prioritise

Operational prerequisites first; review one concrete item per action.

Expose uncertainty

Scenarios, assumptions, freshness and limits travel with the decision.

1 Jul 2026 competitor data: 81 days old; 4 invalid scores excluded. The 12-week period end is unknown.

A shared Azure workflow is a scale option—not a pilot prerequisite

APPENDIX B | Proposed, not deployed. API, sign-in and shared-plan persistence still need building.

